

FIFA World Cup 2026

Prediction Report

Stage: Round of 32

Run date: 2026-06-28 (report created: 2026-06-28)

Headline	Value
Title pick	France (15.8%)
Most likely finalists	France & Spain
Golden Boot pick	Lionel Messi (Argentina) – proj 7.3
Teams simulated	32
Monte Carlo runs	10,000

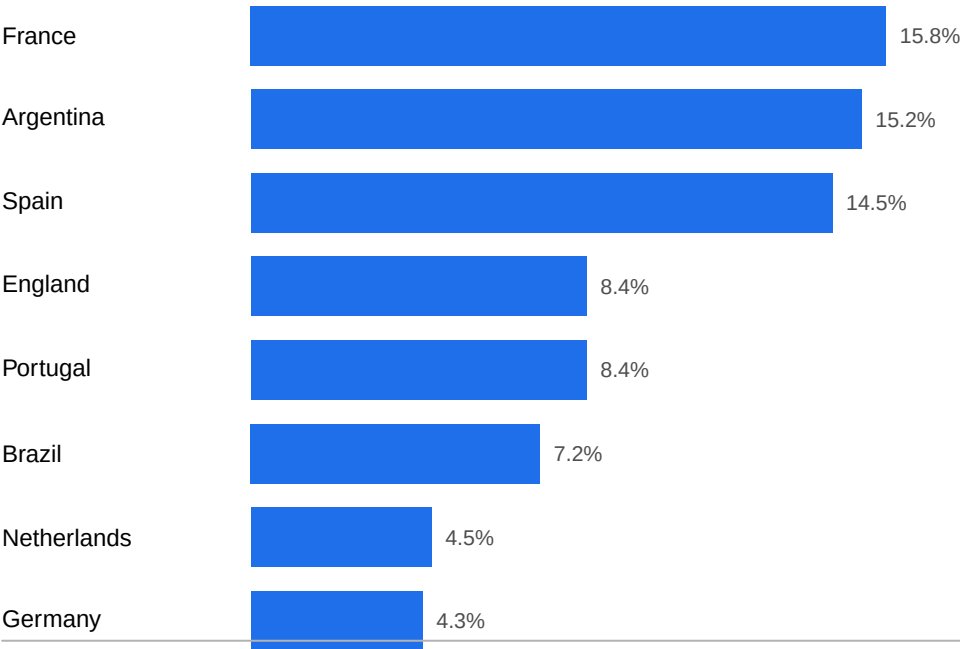
Model: ridge-shrunk Poisson (Dixon-Coles) goal model + Monte Carlo bracket simulation

Tournament Progression

As of 2026-06-26 – probabilities from 10,000 simulations

Team	R16	QF	SF	Final	Win
France	74%	58%	42%	26%	15.8%
Argentina	71%	56%	39%	25%	15.2%
Spain	79%	59%	39%	25%	14.5%
England	80%	52%	27%	16%	8.4%
Portugal	82%	57%	30%	16%	8.4%
Brazil	70%	42%	28%	14%	7.2%
Netherlands	62%	32%	19%	9%	4.5%
Germany	72%	44%	22%	10%	4.3%
Belgium	67%	31%	14%	6%	2.7%
Croatia	66%	36%	16%	7%	2.7%
USA	70%	25%	11%	5%	2.0%
Colombia	55%	30%	12%	5%	1.9%
Mexico	55%	26%	10%	4%	1.6%
Uruguay	29%	17%	8%	4%	1.4%
Switzerland	58%	23%	8%	3%	1.1%
Senegal	45%	21%	8%	3%	1.1%

Title-winning probability



Round of 32 – Match Predictions

Advancer = win the tie; Score = EV-optimal Scorito pick (max expected points)

Match	Tie	Advance	90'	Score	E[pts]
Mexico v Canada *	Projected	Mexico (54%)	Home win	2–1 (9%)	28
Germany v Scotland *	Projected	Germany (72%)	Home win	1–0 (10%)	36
Netherlands v Morocco *	Projected	Netherlands (62%)	Home win	2–1 (9%)	31
Brazil v Japan *	Projected	Brazil (70%)	Home win	1–0 (10%)	36
England v Cape Verde *	Projected	England (81%)	Home win	2–0 (12%)	43
Belgium v Ghana *	Projected	Belgium (67%)	Home win	1–0 (10%)	34
USA v DR Congo *	Projected	USA (70%)	Home win	2–1 (10%)	36
Spain v Austria *	Projected	Spain (79%)	Home win	2–0 (11%)	42
Switzerland v Algeria *	Projected	Switzerland (59%)	Home win	2–1 (9%)	29
Portugal v Saudi Arabia *	Projected	Portugal (82%)	Home win	2–0 (12%)	44
Australia v Egypt *	Projected	Egypt (52%)	Away win	1–2 (8%)	25
Argentina v Uruguay *	Projected	Argentina (71%)	Home win	1–0 (10%)	36
France v Norway *	Projected	France (74%)	Home win	2–0 (10%)	38
Korea Republic v Ecuador *	Projected	Ecuador (52%)	Away win	1–2 (8%)	25
Colombia v Senegal *	Projected	Colombia (55%)	Home win	2–1 (9%)	27
Croatia v Cote d'Ivoire *	Projected	Croatia (66%)	Home win	1–0 (10%)	33

* 16 tie(s) marked Projected use model-estimated participants (group stage not yet final / slot unconfirmed). Confirmed ties are locked from reported results. Update knockout_bracket.csv as matchups are confirmed and re-run.

Top-Scorer Forecast

Projected final goals = current + expected remaining

Golden Boot projection (Proj = goals; Scorito = expected game points)

Player	Team	Now	Exp+	Proj	Scorito
Lionel Messi	Argentina	5	2.27	7.27	61.8
Kylian Mbappe	France	4	2.3	6.3	62.3
Vinicius Junior	Brazil	4	1.52	5.52	38.5
Erling Haaland	Norway	4	0.91	4.91	20
Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	3	1.89	4.89	47
Deniz Undav	Germany	3	1.2	4.2	29
Jonathan David	Canada	3	1.11	4.11	23.4
Harry Kane	England	2	2.01	4.01	49.8
Julian Alvarez	Argentina	2	1.34	3.34	36.3
Alvaro Morata	Spain	2	1.32	3.32	35.2
Romelu Lukaku	Belgium	2	1.2	3.2	27.5
Lamine Yamal	Spain	2	1.2	3.2	32

Scorito top-scorer picks for Round of 32 (position & stage weighted)

Player	Team	Pos	E[pts]
Alphonso Davies	Canada	DF	16.3
Harry Kane	England	FW	13.7
Jamal Musiala	Germany	MF	12.8
Bruno Fernandes	Portugal	MF	12.6
Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	FW	12.5
Kylian Mbappe	France	FW	12
Lionel Messi	Argentina	FW	11.8
Jonathan David	Canada	FW	10.7

Recommendations & Method

How to play these predictions

STRATEGY: Submit the EV-optimal score per tie (max expected Scorito points), not the bare most-likely score -- the toto term dominates, so never pick a draw when a win is favoured. For top scorers, pick by Scorito value (goals x position x stage: a defender/keeper goal pays 4x a forward's), not raw goals -- e.g. Scorito favours Kylian Mbappe over Golden-Boot lead Lionel Messi. Model's title pick: France (15.8%, worth 250 bonus pts).

Champion pick: France (15.8%). Safe R16 backers: Portugal, England, Spain, France, Germany, Argentina.

Methodology

1. Team strength starts from Elo priors adjusted by researched form/injury notes.
2. A Dixon-Coles bivariate Poisson model turns strength into scoreline distributions; parameters are refined by a ridge-penalised fit on observed results (shrinking to priors).
3. A Monte Carlo simulation plays out the bracket many times -> progression probabilities, with extra time and strength-tilted penalty shootouts for knockout ties.
4. Each team's expected goals are shared among its players (form-adjusted) and weighted by how far the team is projected to advance -> per-stage and Golden Boot scorer forecasts.

Data provenance

Verified: group draw, reported group winners, R32 anchor ties, Golden Boot tallies.

Illustrative/projected: unplayed scores and not-yet-confirmed bracket slots.

Refresh input_data/ CSVs with official data and re-run to update everything.